Activity 6

Find out the national parks and wildlife santuaries in Tamil Nadu. Visit those places and collect more information about them.

Advantages of In-situ conservation

- Species can be adapted to their habitat.
- Species can interact with each other.
- Natural habitat is maintained.
- It is less expensive and easy to manage.
- Needs of indigenous people are protected.

22.6.2 Ex-situ Conservation

It is the conservation of wildlife outside their habitat. Establishing zoos and botanical gardens, conservation of genes, seedling and tissue culture are some of the strategies followed in this method.

a. Botanical gardens

It is a place where flowers, fruits and vegetables are grown. These places provide a healthy and calm environment.

b. Zoological parks

Zoological parks are the areas where wild animals are conserved. In India there are about 800 zoological parks.



The oldest zoo is Schoenbrunn Zoo in Vienna, established in the year 1759. In India the first Zoo was established in Barrachpur in the year 1800.

c. Tissue Culture

It is a technique of growing plant cells, tissues, organs, seeds or other plant parts in a sterile environment on a nutrient medium.

d. Seed bank

The seed bank preserves dried seeds by storing them in a very low temperature. The largest seed bank in the world is the Millennium Seed Bank in England.

e. Cryo Bank

It is a technique by which a seed or embryo is preserved at a very low temperature. It is usually preserved in liquid nitrogen at –196ºC. This is helpful for the conservation of species facing extinction.

Advantages of Ex-situ conservation

- It prevents the decline of species.
- Endangered animals can be breeded in these ways.
- Threatened species are breeded and released in natural environment.
- It is useful for conducting research and scientific work.

22.7 PBR (People's Bio-diversity Register)

People's Bio-diversity Register is a document which contains comprehensive information on locally available bio-resources including landscape and demography of a particular area or village. Bio-resources mean plants, animals and microorganisms or parts thereof, their genetic material and by-products with actual or potential use or value. A Bio-diversity Management Committee is set up in each local body according to the provisions of Biological Diversity Act, 2002. This committee prepares the People's Biodiversity Registers with the guidance and technical support of National Biodiversity Authority and the State Biodiversity Boards.

Preparation of this register promotes conservation, preservation of habitats and breed of animals and gathering of knowledge relating to biological diversity. The register entails a complete documentation of biodiversity in the area related to the plant, food source, wildlife, medicinal source, traditional knowledge etc.

22.8 Biomagnification

Biomagnification is the increase in contaminated substances due to the intoxicating environment. The contaminants might be heavy metals such as mercury, arsenic, and pesticides such as polychlorinated biphenyls and DDT (Dichloro Diphenyl Trichloro ethane). These substances are taken up by the organisms through the food they

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